

Ground Yourself.

The 90/10 Rule. Sell You First.

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IN THIS TOOLKIT

- 01 The 90/10 rule
- 02 The grounding stack — You → Company → Product
- 03 Certainty wins
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01 · THE CENTRAL THESIS

The 90/10 Rule

What's actually being bought.

WHAT CLOSES THE BUYER

90% · THE REP + THE BRAND

**10%
PRODUCT**

TWO IMPLICATIONS

Technical depth matters less than you think.

The buyer spends 2 minutes evaluating SEO and 25 evaluating YOU. Product detail closes the last 10% — only if the first 90% is already in place.

Lost deals are rarely about the product.

Reps blame price or contract length. What actually happened was a failure in the first 90%. The product just became the polite reason cited.

CORIE

"90% of every transaction has nothing to do with technical know-how. 90% is how you're connected to the brand and how you feel about the brand. 10% is the product."

02 · THE ORDER

The Grounding Stack

Trust accumulates upward. Sell in this order.

01 · YOU

The human being on the call.

If they don't trust you — nothing closes.

02 · THE COMPANY

The organisation you represent.

If they don't trust the company — you can still defer to your conviction.

03 · THE PRODUCT

The offering itself.

If they trust the first two — the product almost sells itself.

PRE-CALL CHECKLIST · RUN IT MENTALLY

- ◆ Am I grounded in who I am right now? (Yes / No)
- ◆ Am I grounded in why I work here? (Yes / No)
- ◆ Can I name ONE specific reason this agency is the right fit for this buyer? (Yes / No)

ALL THREE = YES BEFORE YOU DIAL. ANY NO = PAUSE AND ANSWER IT FIRST.

03 · THE PRINCIPLE

Certainty Wins

He or she who is most certain has the highest probability.

THE RULE

"He or she who is most certain has the highest probability of getting their point across."

Not who's right — who SOUNDS most sure. Buyers default to the most certain voice.

FALSE CERTAINTY**Overclaiming about everything**

- ✗ Buyer catches a small inconsistency
- ✗ Confidence collapses entirely
- ✗ All the other certainties come into question
- ✗ Deal dies on the next quiet pause

REAL CERTAINTY**Certain about what you KNOW**

- ◆ "I don't know that, but I'll find out."
- ◆ Trust compounds with each honest answer
- ◆ Certainties stay credible
- ◆ Buyer leans in

THE DISCIPLINE

Identify pre-call what you ARE certain about. Lean into those. Don't bluff the rest. Certainty about what you know beats false certainty about everything — by a wide margin.

04 · THE OBJECTION

"Let Me Think About It"

What it actually means — and what to do.

THE WRONG READING

"They want to comparison-shop."

Send more product info. Follow up with the proposal. Quote the package details again. Wait for them to circle back.

RESULT · THEY GHOST

THE RIGHT READING

"I'm not clear about YOU."

Not the product. Not the price. The human being who just spent 30 minutes pitching. They can evaluate the product — they can't yet evaluate the rep.

FIX · MORE YOU. NOT MORE PRODUCT.

THE FOLLOW-UP MOVE

- ◆ Send a personal note, NOT a brochure.
- ◆ Reference something SPECIFIC from the conversation — proves you were listening.
- ◆ Use language that shows you understand the buyer's situation.
- ◆ Skip the product re-pitch entirely. They already heard it.

05 · THE THOUGHT EXPERIMENT

The Filipino Airlines Test

Same plane. Same fuel. Two completely different flights.

FLIGHT A · UNGROUNDED CREW

Crew looks distracted

Glancing at the wings

Take your ticket without warmth

Faint smell of fuel in the cabin

→ **You're tense the whole flight**

→ **Fuel smell makes you nervous**

→ **Every bump feels alarming**

FLIGHT B · GROUNDED CREW

Crew greets you warmly

Helps you with your bag

Settles you into your seat

Faint smell of fuel in the cabin

→ You forget the fuel smell

→ Flight feels safe

→ You read your book

SAME PLANE. SAME FUEL. SAME PHYSICS.

The **ONLY** variable was the crew's connection to the brand. Applied to sales: the rep **IS** the cabin crew. Their warmth and grounding shape whether the buyer interprets normal friction (price, contract length) as red flags — or as ordinary parts of the journey.

A GROUNDED REP MAKES THE BUYER FEEL SAFE. AN UNGROUNDED REP MAKES EVERYTHING FEEL LIKE F

REFERENCE

Daily Card · Keep By the Phone

The whole session on one page.

THE THESIS

- ◆ 90% of every pitch is the rep + the brand. 10% is the product.
- ◆ Buyers don't lose deals on price — they lose them on YOU.
- ◆ Don't try to win the call on product depth. Win it on grounding.

THE STACK

- ◆ Sell yourself first. The company second. The product third.
- ◆ Trust accumulates upward. No buyer trusts product before person.
- ◆ Pre-call: Am I grounded in self? Company? Fit? All yes before you dial.

THE LINES

- ◆ "I could have worked anywhere — I chose this place. Let me tell you why."
- ◆ Followed by 2-3 SPECIFIC reasons (not generic). Write yours down.
- ◆ Be most certain about what you ACTUALLY know. Don't bluff the rest.

THE OBJECTION

- ◆ "Let me think about it" = "I'm not clear about YOU."
- ◆ Follow up with personal, not product. Reference the conversation.
- ◆ Every meeting is a job interview. You're being hired. Earn it.

POWER WORDS COME FROM THE GROUND · THE GROUND IS YOU